

35 YEARS LATER

The surprise and fury of Hurricane Bob



CLOCKWISE FROM TOP: DAVID L. RYAN, BILL GREENE, STAN GROSSFELD, AND MARK WILSON/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Clockwise from top: Boats were scattered over Bridge Street in Dartmouth after Hurricane Bob moved through. During the storm, a woman in Woods Hole ran for cover. The wind was strong enough to hold up a pedestrian who grabbed a pole and kicked up his legs in Boston. A cottage in Falmouth was moved across Surf Drive by the storm.

Storm defied 1991's strong El Niño and hit New England

By Ken Mahan
GLOBE STAFF

Thirty-five years ago, New England learned a lesson that meteorologists still talk about today: It only takes one storm. Nearly all of the hurricane models had been forecasting calm seas. A rather quiet year. But as the Atlantic season was nearing its half-way point in 1991, a surprise storm surfaced off the Bahamas. Days later, Hurricane Bob was on a collision course with New England and on Aug. 19 came ashore not once, but twice in Rhode Island as a Category 2 storm, carving a path

through Southeastern Massachusetts, with destructive winds topping 100 miles per hour and pounding 15-foot storm surges. It later made landfall a third time in Maine. When all was said and done, Bob had killed 18 people from South Carolina to Nova Scotia, including 12 here in New England. The storm caused more than \$1 billion in damage. Dozens of homes were destroyed, countless trees crashed through roofs, torrential rains washed out and ripped up roads, boats were stripped from their moorings and tossed onto lawns, and hundreds of

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Tactic appears to skirt PAC rule

‘Red boxes’ on candidate sites offer strategies

By Kelly Garrity
GLOBE STAFF

Flagging in polling and with his political future on the line, Representative Seth Moulton is taking any shot he can to unseat Senator Ed Markey in their Democratic Senate primary. So late last week, his campaign drew up an eleventh-hour play. The move — laid out in a discreetly placed section of Moulton’s campaign website — called for airing an ad on TV and digital platforms during Thursday’s final primary debate between the two candidates painting the Salem Democrat as “one of Massachusetts’ rising progressive stars” and warning of the wider consequences if the 80-year-old Markey’s “health should falter” should he win another six-year term.

But, it’s not Moulton’s campaign that would run the ad or foot the bill for it. Rather that job would fall to a super PAC backing his bid — which, legally speaking, Moulton isn’t supposed to do game-planning with. But Moulton and other Massachusetts candidates are side-stepping that pesky rule this year thanks to a tactic known as “red-boxing.” The approach — in

RED BOX, Page A7

Teacher taking on Neal in W. Mass.

Says incumbent has lost touch with constituents

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

SPRINGFIELD — People in Western Massachusetts have been seeing a lot of Jeromie Whalen lately. He’s hard to miss. The energetic 39-year-old high school journalism teacher has been crisscrossing the sprawling First Congressional District behind the wheel of a 1988, banana-yellow Toyota van in a long-shot attempt to defeat 19-term Representative Richard Neal in the Sept. 1 Democratic primary. A political novice, Whalen is running to the left of Neal and arguing the congressman has lost touch with his constituents. To try to drive home that contention, Whalen has been showing up at any community event he can find, stopping along the way to knock on the doors of people with his campaign signs on their lawns to personally thank them and take photos. He chronicles it all in nearly real time on social media.

It all has amounted to a surprisingly strong challenge to Neal, 77, an institution in the re-

WHALEN, Page A7



JIM PUZZANGHERA/GLOBE STAFF

Candidate Jeromie Whalen greeted a Westfield voter at an event in Holyoke.

Israel’s military announced its first criminal investigations into troop conduct in the Gaza Strip, focusing on the killings of 5-year-old Hind Rajab, her family, and 15 paramedics. **A3.**

Jurors were offered a glimpse of what Lindsay Clancy’s life has been like since she killed her three children in

2023, and how she feels about what she did. **B1.**

The Massachusetts Clean Energy Center announced \$27 million in tax credits for 18 climate-tech firms. **D1.**

The Red Sox lost to the Diamondbacks, 7-6, in 10 innings. **C1.**

You’ll want to step outside

Thursday: Partly sunny. High: 81-86. Low: 65-70.
Friday: Comfortable. High: 75-80. Low: 61-66.
High tide: 5:43 a.m. 5:58 p.m.
Sunrise: 5:57 Sunset: 7:38
Comics and Weather, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

Major advance in cancer treatment

Dose from Moderna acts like vaccine to curb melanoma recurrence

By Marin Wolf and Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Moderna, the Cambridge biotech that helped contain the pandemic, on Wednesday reported the first successful results of a personalized messenger RNA vaccine in a late-stage trial to treat melanoma, which experts say could foreshadow its use against other cancers. Each dose of the vaccine was tailor-made to the genetic sequence of a patient’s cancer and paired with drugmaker Merck’s blockbuster immunotherapy Keytruda after the cancerous lesion was surgically removed. Melanoma is the deadliest form of skin cancer. Unlike conventional vaccines, which ward off infectious diseases, the trial tested a therapeutic vaccine, called intismeran, that harnesses the body’s immune system to prevent a recurrence or spreading of cancerous lesions. Moderna and its business partner, Merck, said the dual treatment, compared to Keytruda alone, extended how long patients live without the cancer returning, as well as how long they live without new cancerous lesions appearing in other parts of the body. The companies have yet to release detailed data from the randomized Phase 3 clinical trial. But if

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SJC clears way for work at White Stadium

Ruling rejects opponents’ lawsuit, giving Wu a win

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

After more than two years of rising costs and legal pushback, Mayor Michelle Wu’s \$325 million plan to renovate White Stadium in Franklin Park cleared one of its final hurdles Wednesday, allowing the city and a professional women’s soccer team to press ahead with one of the Wu administration’s most ambitious — and polarizing — projects. The Supreme Judicial Court Wednesday rejected a lawsuit trying to halt the project, ruling the overhaul does not violate an arcane state law that protects public parkland, and handing Wu a major legal and political victory. The stadium renovation has drawn intense scrutiny and criticism, both over the scale of the project and its escalating price tag, and at times was featured prominently on the campaign trail during her successful reelection bid a year ago. The ruling officially also puts an end to a years-long lawsuit to stop the controversial project, brought by the environmental nonprofit the Emerald Necklace Conservancy and a coalition of residents who live in the neighborhoods surrounding Franklin Park.

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Work continued at White Stadium last week.

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